

PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

Task 2

Phishing Email Detection & Awareness System

Future Interns Cyber Security Internship

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OBJECTIVE

The objective of this task is to analyze email messages and identify potential phishing attempts by examining sender information, email content, links, and other suspicious indicators. The assessment aims to classify emails as Safe, Suspicious, or Phishing and promote cybersecurity awareness through practical examples and prevention guidelines.

TOOLS USED

- Email Samples
- Notepad
- Browser Tools
- Canva
- PDF Documentation

INTRODUCTION TO PHISHING

Phishing is a common cyber attack technique used by attackers to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, or personal data. These attacks are usually carried out through deceptive emails that appear to come from trusted organizations. Phishing emails often create a sense of urgency, contain suspicious links, or imitate legitimate brands to gain the recipient's trust. Understanding phishing indicators is essential for preventing security incidents and protecting personal and organizational information.

METHODOLOGY

The email samples were examined to identify common phishing indicators such as suspicious sender addresses, look-alike domains, urgency in language, and potentially malicious links. Each email was analyzed based on its sender information, subject line, message content, and overall legitimacy. Based on the observed indicators, the emails were classified as Safe, Suspicious, or Phishing. The findings were then documented to improve phishing awareness and support secure email practices.

SAFE EMAIL ANALYSIS

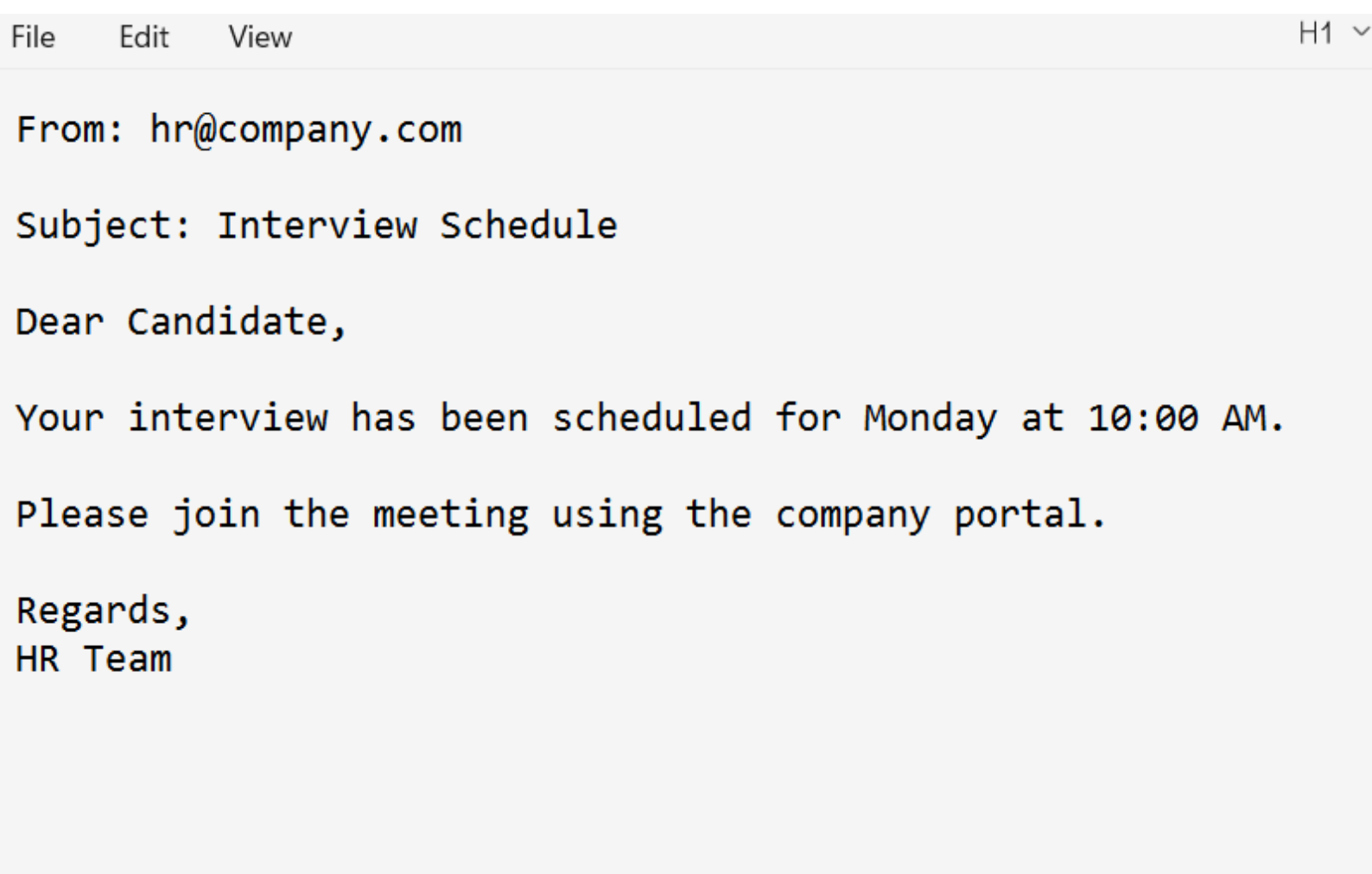


Figure 1: Example of a legitimate email with no suspicious indicators.

Classification: Safe

Indicators Observed:

- Legitimate sender address
- No urgency or threatening language
- No suspicious links or attachments
- No request for sensitive information

SUSPICIOUS EMAIL ANALYSIS

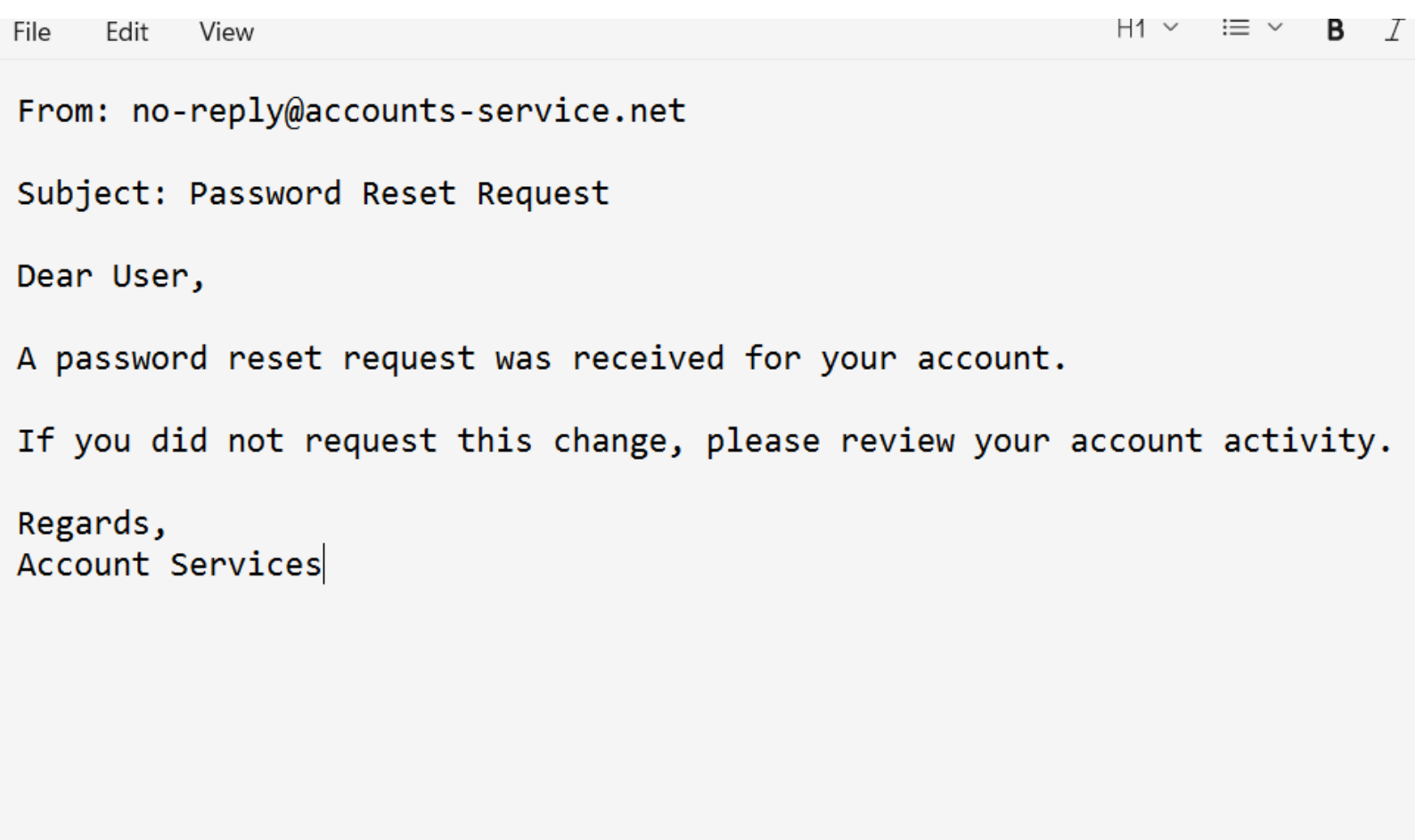


Figure 2: Example of an email containing suspicious characteristics that require further verification.

Classification: Suspicious

Indicators Observed:

- Generic sender domain
- Unexpected account-related notification
- Slightly suspicious wording
- Requires further verification before taking action

PHISHING EMAIL ANALYSIS

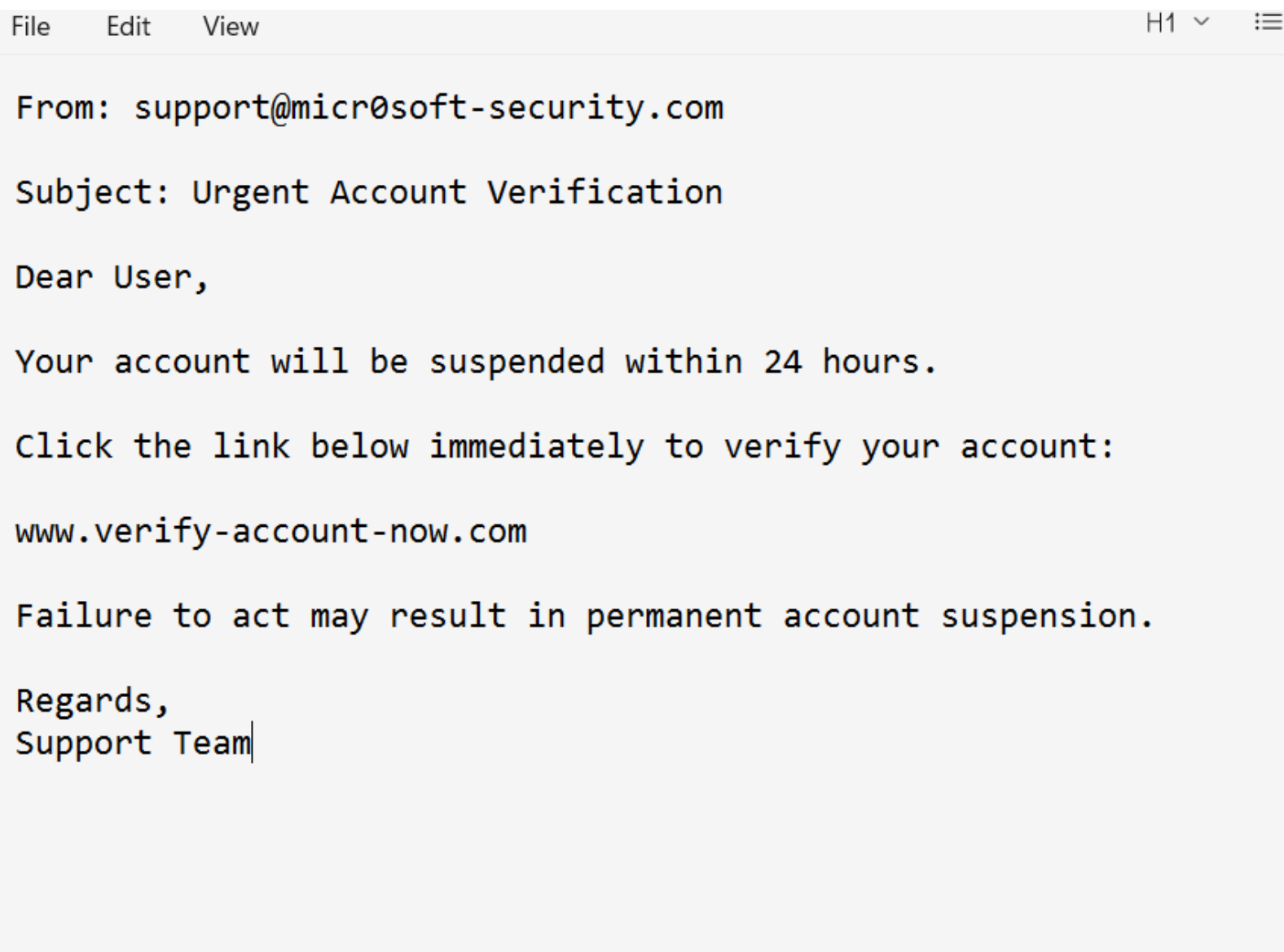


Figure 3: Example of a phishing email designed to trick users into revealing sensitive information.

Classification: Phishing

Indicators Observed:

- Look-alike sender domain
- Creates urgency
- Suspicious verification link
- Requests immediate action
- High phishing risk

PHISHING TECHNIQUES

Common phishing techniques include email spoofing, look-alike domains, malicious links, and social engineering tactics. Attackers often impersonate trusted organizations and create a sense of urgency to trick users into revealing sensitive information. Understanding these techniques helps individuals identify potential threats and respond safely.

Another common tactic is the use of deceptive messages that encourage users to click on fraudulent links or download malicious attachments. These emails are carefully designed to appear legitimate, making it important for users to verify the sender, inspect links carefully, and remain cautious when handling unexpected messages.

PHISHING AWARENESS & PREVENTION GUIDELINES

1. Always verify the sender's email address before responding to any message.
2. Avoid clicking on suspicious links or downloading unexpected attachments.
3. Be cautious of emails that create urgency or request sensitive information.
4. Check website URLs carefully before entering login credentials.
5. Report suspected phishing emails to the appropriate security team or service provider.

CONCLUSION

This assessment examined different email examples to identify phishing indicators and classify messages as Safe, Suspicious, or Phishing. The analysis highlighted common warning signs such as fake domains, urgent language, and suspicious links. By recognizing these indicators and following security best practices, users can reduce the risk of phishing attacks and protect sensitive information.

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